BOSS & FRIENDS
CONSTRUCTION LTD.

FREE HOMEOWNER GUIDE

10 QUESTIONS TO ASK BEFORE YOU HIRE ANY CONTRACTOR

A good contractor answers every one of these without blinking. If someone gets vague, defensive or says "don't worry about it", you've learned what you needed to know. Works for any trade: foundations, framing, roofing, renos.

HOMEOWNERS | FIRST-TIME BUILDERS | LANDLORDS & INVESTORS

01 **"Are you registered with WorkSafeBC? Can I get a clearance letter?"**

Clearance letters are free and quick to request online. **If you hire a contractor who isn't registered or in good standing, you can be held liable for their unpaid premiums.**

02 **"What liability insurance do you carry? Can I see the certificate?"**

Check the name matches the company you're hiring and that the dates are current. If something gets damaged, this is what pays for it, not you.

03 **Building a new home? "Are you a licensed residential builder, and is home warranty insurance in place?"**

In BC, new homes generally need a builder licensed through BC Housing and third-party home warranty coverage. You can look up a builder's licence yourself.

04 **"Who's pulling the permit?"**

The contractor should. **Red flag:** "We don't need a permit for this", or asking you to take out the permit in your name so it's your problem.

05 **"Can I see similar jobs you've done and call two past clients?"**

Photos of real jobs, not stock images. Ask the past clients one thing: **"Would you hire them again?"**

06 **"What exactly is included, and what isn't? Can I get that in writing?"**

A line-by-line scope beats a one-number quote. Watch for "allowances" (placeholder budgets) that can quietly grow, and ask who handles cleanup, disposal and site restoration.

07 "What's the payment schedule?"

Pay for work that's done, tied to milestones (e.g. "foundation poured and inspected"), not dates. Be careful with a big deposit before anything happens on site. Ask how they handle the **10% holdback under BC's Builders Lien Act**.

08 "Who's on site every day, and who's my one point of contact?"

Know whether it's their own crew or subtrades, and who picks up the phone when something comes up.

09 "How do changes work?"

Every change gets a written change order with the price and any schedule impact **before** the work is done. No surprise bills at the end.

10 "What's the timeline, what could delay it, and how will you keep me updated?"

Weather, inspections and material delivery are real. What matters is that they tell you early. Ask for regular photo updates; good crews already take them.

Walk away if you hear: cash only · no written contract · big deposit before any work · "we don't need a permit" · "sign today and I'll give you a deal" · no proof of WorkSafeBC or insurance.

COMPARE YOUR QUOTES

FILL ONE COLUMN PER CONTRACTOR

CHECK	CONTRACTOR A	CONTRACTOR B	CONTRACTOR C
WorkSafeBC clearance letter			
Insurance certificate seen			
Written, line-by-line scope			
Permit pulled by contractor			
Two references called			
Milestone payment schedule			
Total price			